

Ke Li

Personal Website: <https://kelichloe.github.io>

Education

INSEAD

Ph.D. Candidate in Decision Sciences

France

Sep 2023 – Present

Advisor: Spyros Zoumpoulis

Dissertation Committee: Spyros Zoumpoulis, Phanish Puranam, Antoine Desir, and Yuting Zhu.

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen

China

B.Eng. (Hons.) in Computer Science and Engineering

Sep 2018 – Jun 2022

Honors & Awards

Research & Academic Honors

- OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$1,000 in API credits) 2026
- *Stars of Tomorrow* Award for Outstanding Intern, Microsoft Research Asia 2022
- ExploreCSR Computing Research Award, Google Research & UTRGV [\[link\]](#) 2021
- China National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China 2019
- Dean's List, CUHK-Shenzhen 2019–2020
- Undergraduate Admission Fellowship, CUHK-Shenzhen 2018–2022

Teaching Honors

- Teaching Excellence Award in PhD Tutorials, INSEAD 2025
- Undergraduate Student Teaching Fellow, CUHK-Shenzhen 2020

Research

My research lies at the intersection of artificial intelligence, machine learning, optimization, and decision sciences. I pursue two complementary research streams. For a complete publication list, see my [Google Scholar profile](#).

Research Stream 1: AI for Better Science

Investigating how artificial intelligence can augment scientific discovery and theory building, with a focus on human–AI complementarity and scientific reasoning.

- [1] [Artificial Intelligences and Human Scientists Exhibit Complementary Strengths in Theory Building](#).

Ke Li, Spyros I. Zoumpoulis, Phanish Puranam, Philip M. Parker, . . . , and Eric Luis Uhlmann. *Preprint*, 2026.

Research Stream 2: AI for Better Decisions

Developing machine learning and optimization methods to improve decision-making under uncertainty, with applications to sequential decision-making, customer segmentation, targeting, and personalization.

[2] **Decision-Aware Segmentation.**

Joint work with Sandeep Chandukala, Ernst Osinga, and Spyros Zoumpoulis. Working paper; draft available upon request.

Best Paper Award, Singapore Rising Scholars Conference (SMU), 2026.

Presented at (2026): INFORMS Annual Meeting (San Francisco); M&SOM Conference (Harvard); ISMS Conference (Lisbon); Theory + Practice in Marketing (ESADE).

[3] **Learning from Visual Observation via Offline Pretrained State-to-Go Transformer.**

Bohan Zhou, **Ke Li**, Jiechuan Jiang, and Zongqing Lu. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* (NeurIPS), 2023.

[4] **Combinatorial Bandits under Strategic Manipulations.**

Jing Dong, **Ke Li**, Shuai Li, and Baoxiang Wang. *ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining* (WSDM), 2022.

Industry Experiences

Beijing Academy of Artificial Intelligence

Beijing

Reinforcement Learning Researcher (Full-time)

12/2022 - 07/2023

- Designed and trained intelligent agents capable of learning directly from high-dimensional visual observations in complex game environments such as Minecraft.
- Developed novel architectures combining convolutional encoders with deep reinforcement learning algorithms (e.g., PPO, DQN)

Microsoft Research Asia

Beijing

Research Intern, Award of Excellent Intern

01/2022 - 06/2022

- Contributed to Microsoft's AutoML toolkit [NNI](#) (14,400+ GitHub stars), including transformer model-compression modules now integrated into both internal and external AutoML pipelines.
- Investigated model compression techniques for Transformer/BERT models, such as pruning, quantization, and distillation; optimized Transformer models for deployment by reducing parameters and memory footprint.

Shanghai AI Laboratory (SenseTime OpenDILab)

Shenzhen

Reinforcement Learning Intern

08/2021 - 12/2021

- Contributed 1,600+ lines of code to the open-source [DI-engine](#) reinforcement learning framework (3,600+ GitHub stars).

ByteDance Technology

Beijing

Machine Learning Intern, Data AI Lab

12/2020 - 05/2021

Teaching Experience

INSEAD

France

Teaching Assistant

Teaching Excellence Award in PhD Tutorials, 2025

- Foundations of AI for Managers (MBA) 2025.05 - 2025.06
- Foundations of AI for Managers (MBA) 2025.01 - 2025.02
- Probability and Statistics (PhD) 2024.10 - 2024.12

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant (Selective Program)
• MAT1010 Calculus I

China

2019.09 - 2019.12

Academic Service

Session Chair

- INFORMS Annual Meeting (co-chair with Spyros Zoumpoulis) 2026
Advances in Data-Driven Decisions
- INFORMS Annual Meeting (co-chair with Spyros Zoumpoulis) 2025
Estimation and Optimization in Data-Driven Decisions

Conference Reviewer

- NeurIPS 2024

Beyond Academia

Fashion modeling in Paris ([Portfolio](#)).
Piano (Grade 10 Certification).

Media & Features

Featured in a student interview by The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen ([English version](#) / [Chinese version](#)).